Question ID 14e7c1f4

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Geometry and Trigonometry	Right triangles and trigonometry	

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For two acute angles, $\angle Q$ and $\angle R$, $\cos(Q) = \sin(R)$. The measures, in degrees, of $\angle Q$ and $\angle R$ are $x + 61$ and $4x + 4$, respectively. What is the value of x?

A. 5

B. 19

C. 23

D. 29

ID: 14e7c1f4 Answer

Correct Answer:
A

Rationale

Choice A is correct. It's given that for two acute angles, $\angle Q$ and $\angle R$, $\cos(Q) = \sin(R)$. For two acute angles, if the sine of one angle is equal to the cosine of the other angle, the angles are complementary. It follows that $\angle Q$ and $\angle R$ are complementary. That is, the sum of the measures of the angles is 90 degrees. It's given that the measure of $\angle Q$ is $x + 61$ degrees and the measure of $\angle R$ is $4x + 4$ degrees. It follows that $(x + 61) + (4x + 4) = 90$. By combining like terms, this equation can be rewritten as $5x + 65 = 90$. Subtracting 65 from each side of this equation yields $5x = 25$. Dividing each side of this equation by 5 yields $x = 5$.

Choice B is incorrect. This would be the value of x if $\cos(Q) = \cos(R)$ rather than $\cos(Q) = \sin(R)$.

Choice C is incorrect. This would be the value of x if $\cos(Q) = -\cos(R)$ rather than $\cos(Q) = \sin(R)$ and if $\angle R$ were obtuse rather than acute.

Choice D is incorrect and may result from conceptual or calculation errors.

Question Difficulty:
Hard